

CySA+ Acronyms

blue indicates new (was not already in A+, Net+, or Security+ list)

	ACRONYM	MEANING	DEFINITION
1	ACL	Access Control List	A set of rules attached to resources specifying who can access what and what actions are allowed.
2	API	Application Programming Interface	A set of protocols allowing different software applications to communicate securely.
3	APT	Advanced Persistent Threat	A prolonged targeted cyberattack in which attackers remain undetected for a long period.
4	ARP	Address Resolution Protocol	A protocol used to map IP addresses to physical MAC addresses in a local network.
5	AV	Antivirus	Software that detects prevents and removes malicious software from systems.
6	ASVS	Application Security Verification Standard	A framework for testing and validating the security of web applications.
7	ATT&CK	Adversarial Tactics Techniques and Common Knowledge	MITRE framework for understanding attacker behaviors and methods
8	BC	Business Continuity	Ability to keep critical operations running during/after disruptions.
9	BCP	Business Continuity Planning	The process of creating systems to recover operations during and after a crisis.
10	BEAST	Browser Exploit Against SSL/TLS	An attack that exploits weaknesses in older TLS/SSL encryption to help recover sensitive data.
11	BGP	Border Gateway Protocol	A routing protocol used to exchange routing information between autonomous systems on the internet.
12	BIA	Business Impact Analysis	A process to predict and evaluate the impact of disruption to business functions.
13	BIOS	Basic Input / Output	Firmware that initializes hardware and starts the computer boot process.
14	BREACH	Browser Reconnaissance & Exfiltration via Adaptive Compression of Hypertext	A web attack that uses HTTP compression to extract secret data from encrypted HTTPS responses.
15	C2	Command and Control	Attacker system used to manage compromised devices.
16	CA	Certificate Authority	A trusted organization that issues digital certificates to verify identity and enable secure communications.
17	CASB	Cloud Access Security Broker	A software tool or service that sits between users and cloud services to enforce security policies.
18	CBC	Cipher Block Chain	A block-cipher mode where each plaintext block is combined with the previous ciphertext block before encryption.
19	CDN	Content Delivery Network	Distributed system that delivers content quickly and reliably.
20	CERT	Computer Emergency Response Team	A group that responds to cybersecurity incidents and helps mitigate their effects.
21	CHD	Cardholder Data	Information tied to credit/debit cardholders.

22	CI/CD	Continuous Integration and Continuous Delivery	Automating code build, testing, and deployment.
23	CIS	Center for Internet Security	Creates cybersecurity benchmarks and best practices.
24	CMS	Content Management System	Software used to create, manage, and publish website content.
25	COBIT	Control Objectives for Information and Related Technologies	Framework for IT governance and management.
26	CPU	Central Processing Unit	The main processor that executes instructions and performs calculations for the computer.
27	CSF	Cybersecurity Framework	A set of best-practice guidelines for managing cybersecurity risk (commonly referring to the NIST Cybersecurity Framework).
28	CSIRT	Cybersecurity Incident Response Team	Handles and responds to security incidents.
29	CSRF	Cross-site Request Forgery	A web attack where users are tricked into performing actions they didn't intend while authenticated.
30	CVE	Common Vulnerability Enumeration	A standardized identifier for known security vulnerabilities.
31	CVSS	Common Vulnerability Scoring System	A numerical scoring system to rate the severity of software vulnerabilities.
32	DAST	Dynamic Application Security Testing	Security testing that scans a running application from the outside to find vulnerabilities.
33	DDoS	Distributed Denial of Service	A type of attack that overwhelms a service with traffic from multiple sources causing disruption or shutdown.
34	DEP	Data Execution Prevention	Security feature that blocks code from running in memory regions not designated for execution helping prevent exploits
35	DHCP	Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol	Protocol that automatically assigns IP addresses and network settings to devices on a network
36	DKIM	DomainKeys Identified Mail	An email authentication method that verifies a sender's domain using a digital signature to prevent spoofing.
37	DLL	Dynamic Link Library	Shared library of code used by multiple programs in Windows allowing modular and efficient software functionality
38	DLP	Data Loss Prevention	Tools and strategies used to prevent unauthorized access transmission or leakage of sensitive information.
39	DMARC	Domain Message Authentication Reporting and Conformance	An email validation system that uses SPF and DKIM to prevent phishing and provides reporting.
40	DNS	Domain Name System	A naming system that translates human-readable domain names into IP addresses computers use to identify each other.
41	DoH	DNS over HTTPS	A method of sending DNS queries over HTTPS to improve privacy and reduce tampering.

42	DoS	Denial of Service	Attack that aims to shut down a service or system by flooding it with traffic or triggering resource exhaustion
43	DR	Disaster Recovery	Restoring IT systems and data after disruptions.
44	EDR	Endpoint Detection and Response	A security solution that monitors endpoints for malicious activity and provides real-time threat response.
45	EOF	End Of File	A marker that indicates no more data can be read from a file or data stream.
46	FIM	File Integrity Management	A process that monitors and detects changes to files helping identify unauthorized modifications or corruption.
47	FTK	Forensic Toolkit	A digital forensics tool used to acquire, analyze, and report on evidence from computers and storage media.
48	FTP	File Transfer Protocol	Standard for transferring files between systems.
49	GDB	GNU Debugger	Tool for analyzing and debugging program behavior.
50	GPG	GNU Privacy Guard	An encryption/signing tool used to protect data and verify authenticity using public-key cryptography.
51	GPO	Group Policy Object	A collection of settings in Windows used to control user and computer configurations in an Active Directory environment.
52	HIDS	Host-based Intrusion Detection System	Software that monitors a single system for suspicious activity or policy violations.
53	HIPS	Host-based Intrusion Prevention System	Software that detects and actively blocks malicious behavior on an individual host.
54	HTML	Hypertext Markup Language	Standard language used to create and format content for web pages
55	HTTP	Hypertext Transfer Protocol	A protocol used to request and transfer web pages over the internet typically on port 80.
56	HTTPD	Hypertext Transfer Protocol Daemon	A web server daemon (service) that handles HTTP requests and serves web pages.
57	HTTPS	Hypertext Transfer Protocol Secure	The encrypted version of HTTP using TLS/SSL to secure web communications.
58	IaaS	Infrastructure as a Service	Cloud-delivered virtualized computing resources.
59	IAM	Identity and Access Management	Framework for ensuring the right individuals access the right resources at the right times
60	ICMP	Internet Control Message Protocol	A network protocol used for sending error messages and operational information about IP traffic.
61	ICS	Industrial Control Systems	Networked systems used to monitor and control industrial processes often targeted in critical infrastructure attacks.
62	IDOR	Insecure Direct Object Reference	Critical access control vulnerability occurring when an application uses user-supplied input to directly access internal objects (e.g., database keys, files) without proper authorization checks. Attackers exploit this by manipulating IDs in URLs or parameters to access or modify unauthorized data

63	IDS	Intrusion Detection System	A system that monitors network or system activity for signs of security breaches or malicious behavior.
64	IIS	Internet Information Services	Microsoft's web server platform used to host websites and web applications.
65	IoC	Indicators of Compromise	Evidence or artifacts that suggest a system has been breached or is under attack.
66	IP	Internet Protocol	The primary protocol for sending data across networks assigning addresses and routing packets.
67	IPS	Intrusion Prevention System	A system that actively monitors and blocks detected threats or unauthorized activity in real-time.
68	IR	Incident Response	The process of detecting analyzing and responding to security incidents to minimize damage.
69	ISO	International Standards Organization	An international body that creates standards for technology including information security (e.g. ISO/IEC 27001).
70	ISP	Internet Service Provider	Company that provides access to the internet for individuals and organizations
71	IT	Information Technology	Use of computers, networks, and systems for data.
72	ITIL	Information Technology Infrastructure Library	Framework for IT service management best practices.
73	JSON	JavaScript Object Notation	Lightweight data exchange format.
74	KPI	Key Performance Indicator	Metric to measure progress toward goals.
75	LAN	Local Area Network	Network covering a small, local area (e.g., office).
76	LDAPS	Lightweight Directory Access Protocol	A protocol used to access and maintain directory information like usernames and credentials.
77	LFI	Local File Inclusion	Vulnerability allowing execution of local files.
78	LOI	Letter of Intent	Preliminary agreement document.
79	LSASS	Local Security Authority Subsystem Service	A Windows process that enforces security policy and handles user authentication and token creation.
80	MAC	Media Access Control	A unique hardware identifier assigned to network interfaces for communications on the physical network.
81	MD5	Message Digest 5	Cryptographic hash function used for checksums now considered insecure due to vulnerability to collisions
82	MFA	Multifactor Authentication	A security method that requires two or more types of credentials for user authentication.
83	MOU	Memorandum of Understanding	A non-binding agreement that outlines terms and expectations for collaboration between entities.
84	MSF	Metasploit Framework	Security tool for penetration testing and exploitation.
85	MSP	Managed Service Provider	A third-party company that remotely manages a customer's IT infrastructure and end-user systems.
86	MSRPC	Microsoft Remote Procedure Call	Microsoft's implementation of Remote Procedure Call used for inter-process and network-based service requests.

87	MSSP	Managed Security Service Provider	A third-party vendor that provides outsourced monitoring and management of security systems.
88	MTTD	Mean Time to Detect	Average time to discover a security incident.
89	NAC	Network Access Control	A security solution that enforces policies for device compliance before allowing network access.
90	NDA	Non-disclosure Agreement	Contract protecting confidential information.
91	NGFW	Next-generation Firewall	An advanced firewall with features like deep packet inspection intrusion prevention and application awareness.
92	NIDS	Network-based Intrusion Detection System	A system that monitors network traffic for signs of malicious activity or policy violations.
93	NIPS	Network-based Intrusion Prevention System	Security system that inspects network traffic and blocks threats in real time
94	NIST	National Institute of Standards & Technology	US agency that develops cybersecurity standards and guidelines including the NIST Cybersecurity Framework
95	NTP	Network Time Protocol	A protocol used to synchronize clocks between systems over a network critical for accurate logging and security.
96	NOC	Network Operations Center	A centralized team/location that monitors networks and systems to keep services available and stable.
97	OpenVAS	Open Vulnerability Assessment Scanner	Standard for security testing.
98	OS	Operating System	The core software that manages hardware and software resources and provides services for applications.
99	OSINT	Open-source Intelligence	Publicly available information (like websites or social media) used for investigative or threat intelligence purposes
100	OSSTMM	Open-Source Security Testing Methodology Manual	Standard for security testing.
101	OSVDB	Open-Source Vulnerability DB	A database that catalogs publicly disclosed software vulnerabilities (historically community-driven).
102	OT	Operational Technology	Systems used to control industrial equipment like SCADA often found in manufacturing or utilities.
103	OUI	Organizationally Unique Identifier	A manufacturer identifier used in the first part of a MAC address to identify the vendor.
104	OWASP	Open Web Application Security Project	Web app security nonprofit and resources.
105	PAM	Privileged Access Management	Tools and strategies used to monitor and control accounts with elevated access rights to reduce risk.
106	PCI DSS	Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard	A set of standards ensuring secure handling of credit card information.

107	PHP	Hypertext Preprocessor	Widely used server-side scripting language.
108	PID	Process Identifier	Unique number assigned to a running process.
109	PII	Personally Identifiable Information	Any data that can identify a person such as name SSN or email critical for data privacy.
110	PKI	Public Key Infrastructure	A framework for managing digital certificates and public-key encryption to support secure communications.
111	PLC	Programmable Logic Controller	Industrial computer for automation.
112	POC	Proof of Concept	Demo showing feasibility of an idea or exploit.
113	RADIUS	Remote Authentication Dial-in User Service	Centralized protocol for authentication authorization and accounting in remote access
114	RCE	Remote Code Execution	Vulnerability enabling remote attacker code execution.
115	RDP	Remote Desktop Protocol	A Microsoft protocol that allows users to remotely access and control a Windows computer.
116	REST	Representational State Transfer	Web service design style using standard HTTP.
117	RFI	Remote File Inclusion	Vulnerability letting attackers load remote files.
118	RPC	Remote Procedure Call	A protocol that lets a program request a service or execute a function on another system remotely.
119	RPO	Recovery Point Objective	Maximum acceptable amount of data loss measured in time used in disaster recovery planning
120	RSA	Rivest Shamir & Adleman	Widely used asymmetric encryption algorithm known for secure data transmission.
121	RTO	Recovery Time Objective	Target time to restore systems and operations, including data, after a disruption or disaster.
122	RXSS	Reflected Cross-site Scripting	Injection attack bouncing malicious code to a user.
123	SaaS	Software as a Service	A cloud computing model where applications are delivered over the internet and maintained by a provider.
124	SAML	Security Assertions Markup Language	An XML-based standard used for exchanging authentication and authorization data between parties.
125	SAMM	Software Assurance Maturity Model	A maturity model used to assess and improve an organization's software security practices.
126	SASE	Secure Access Service Edge	A cloud-delivered architecture that combines networking and security into one service.
127	SAST	Static Application Security Testing	Security testing that analyzes source code (without running it) to find vulnerabilities.
128	SCADA	Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition	A control system used for industrial processes like power plants and water treatment.
129	SDLC	Software Development Lifecycle	A structured process for planning developing testing and deploying software systems.
130	SDN	Software-defined Networking	An approach that separates the control plane from the data plane for flexible and programmable network management.
131	SFTP	Secured File Transfer Protocol	A secure version of FTP that uses SSH to encrypt file transfers and protect data in transit.
132	SIEM	Security Information and Event Management	A centralized solution for collecting analyzing and correlating security data in real time.

133	SLA	Service-level Agreement	A contract between a service provider and customer that outlines performance availability and responsibilities
134	SLO	Service-level Objective	Performance or reliability target for a service.
135	SMB	Server Message Block	Network protocol for sharing files printers and serial ports between nodes on a network
136	SMS	Short Message Service	Text messaging service used in mobile devices sometimes leveraged in security notifications or MFA
137	SMTP	Simple Mail Transfer Protocol	Protocol used to send email from clients to servers and between servers
138	SNI	SMS Notification Indicator	Protocol used for exchanging structured information in web services using XML
139	SNMP	Simple Network Management Protocol	Protocol used to monitor and manage devices on a network such as routers and switches
140	SOAP	Simple Object Access Protocol	A protocol for exchanging structured messages between systems, often using XML over HTTP.
141	SOAR	Security Orchestration Automation Response	A platform that integrates security tools to automate and streamline incident response.
142	SOC	Security Operations Center	A centralized team and facility that monitors and manages an organization's security posture.
143	SPF	Sender Policy Framework	An email validation system designed to prevent spoofing by verifying sender IPs.
144	SQL	Structured Query Language	A standard language used for managing and querying databases.
145	SQLi	SQL Injection	Type of attack where malicious SQL code is inserted into input fields to access or manipulate a database
146	SSH	Secure Shell	Protocol that provides secure remote command-line access and encrypted data communication
147	SSID	Service Set Identifier	The broadcast name that identifies a Wi-Fi network.
148	SSL	Secure Sockets Layer	An older encryption protocol used to secure web communications now deprecated in favor of TLS.
149	SSO	Single Sign-on	A user authentication process that allows access to multiple systems with one set of credentials.
150	SSRF	Server-side Request Forgery	Attack tricking a server into making requests.
151	STIX	Structured Threat Information eXchange	A standardized format for sharing threat intelligence across organizations.
152	SWG	Secure Web Gateway	A security solution that filters web traffic to prevent access to malicious websites and enforce policy.
153	TCP	Transmission Control Protocol	Communication protocols that governs how data is transmitted across networks.
154	TFTP	Trivial File Transfer Protocol	Simple, lightweight file transfer system.
155	TLS	Transport Layer Security	A cryptographic protocol that ensures privacy and data integrity between applications over a network.
156	TRACE	Trade Reporting and Compliance Engine	FINRA system for reporting bond trades.
157	TTP	Tactics Techniques and Procedures	A cybersecurity framework describing how attackers operate and organize their behavior.

158	UDP	User Datagram Protocol	Connectionless communication protocol used for fast data transmission but with no error correction
159	UEBA	User and Entity Behavior Analytics	Security using behavior patterns to detect threats.
160	URI	Uniform Resource Identifier	A general identifier used to locate or identify resources on the internet including URLs and URNs.
161	URL	Universal Resource Locator	A specific type of URI that provides the address to access resources on the internet (e.g. https://example.com).
162	USB	Universal Serial Bus	A common interface used to connect peripherals to computers; can be a vector for malware if unmanaged.
163	UTC	Universal Time Coordinated	The primary global time standard used for consistent timekeeping and synchronization.
164	VLAN	Virtual Local Area Network	A logical grouping of devices on a network segmented by function or department improving security.
165	VM	Virtual Machine	A software-emulated computer system that runs an OS and apps independently of the physical host system.
166	VPN	Virtual Private Network	A secure connection over the internet that encrypts data between a user and a private network.
167	WAF	Web Application Firewall	A security filter that monitors and blocks malicious traffic targeting web applications.
168	WAN	Wide Area Network	Network spanning a large geographic area.
169	XDR	Extended Detection and Response	A cybersecurity approach that integrates threat data across endpoints networks and servers for holistic response.
170	XML	Extensible Markup Language	A flexible format for storing and transporting structured data often used in web and security applications
171	XSS	Cross-site Scripting	A web vulnerability where attackers inject malicious scripts into websites viewed by other users.
172	XXE	XML External Entity	XML parsing flaw that can expose or alter data.
173	ZAP	Zed Attack Proxy	Open-source web app security testing tool.
174	ZTA	Zero Trust Architecture	Security approach assumes no implicit trust and requires verification for every access request.
175	ZTNA	Zero Trust Network Access	Security model requiring verification for every connection.